Jay-Z Closes His Tour With Surprise Guests in Los Angeles

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Jay-Z closed his tour with a night full of surprises. At his second concert at Los Angeles' SoFi Stadium, the final gig of the Jay-Z 30 Tour, he brought out Snoop Dogg, Dr. Dre, and Too Short. Too Short was the first guest to take the stage, performing his 2006 hit Blow the Whistle, with Jay-Z adding his Playoff **freestyle** to the track. Later in the show, Jay-Z performed his own song D'Evils over the beat of a Snoop Dogg song, and at that point Snoop Dogg came out onstage. Dr. Dre was next, and Jay-Z handed the stage to the duo, who performed a **medley** of The Next Episode, California Love, Nothin' But a 'G' Thang, and Still D.R.E. It was a celebration of decades of hip-hop history, all in one set. Before the gig, there were unconfirmed reports on social media that ticket prices for Saturday's show had fallen, with tickets even being given away for free. During **Encore**, Jay-Z addressed the **rumours**, and artificial intelligence in general. He told the crowd to be really real about what is going on in the world, and to trust what they could see and hear for themselves. He said people might tell them nobody was there, or that the music was not great, but they had eyes and ears of their own. His message was simple: question everything you feel, especially in a world where technology can trick people. The previous night at SoFi, Jay-Z had brought out his own daughter Blue Ivy for The Story of O.J. and Dead Presidents, Geto Boys' Scarface for This Can't Be Life and Mind Playing Tricks, and DJ Khaled and John Legend for a show-ending God Did. The **retrospective** Jay-Z 30 Tour opened in July with three star-studded nights at New York's Yankee Stadium, followed by gigs in London and Paris. The Los Angeles finale brought that journey to a close with friends, old songs, and a packed stadium singing along.

Word Treasure

medley -- A set of short parts of different songs sung one after another.
freestyle -- Rapping made up on the spot, not written down first.
rumours -- Stories going around that have not been confirmed as true.
retrospective -- Looking back over a long career or history.
Encore -- The extra part of a concert after the main show ends.

Background you need

A concert tour is a series of live shows by a musician in different cities, and a finale is the last show of that run.

Hip-hop is a style of music built around rapping, beats, and DJing, with a long history of artists working together on stage.

Surprise guests are performers who appear without being announced in advance, which can make a final night feel special for the crowd.

Jay-Z's Los Angeles show closed a tour that had opened in New York and then visited London and Paris before reaching its final stadium night.

Break it down

LEAD: Jay-Z closes his tour with a night full of surprises in Los Angeles.

KEY EVENT: At his second concert at Los Angeles' SoFi Stadium, the final gig of the Jay-Z 30 Tour, he brings out Snoop Dogg, Dr. Dre, and Too Short.

+- FIRST GUEST: Too Short performs his 2006 hit Blow the Whistle, with Jay-Z adding his Playoff freestyle.

+- THEN: Jay-Z performs D'Evils over a Snoop Dogg beat, and Snoop Dogg comes out onstage.

+- FINALE SET: Dr. Dre joins them for a medley of The Next Episode, California Love, Nothin' But a 'G' Thang, and Still D.R.E.

EVIDENCE: Before the gig, there were unconfirmed reports on social media that ticket prices for Saturday's show had fallen, with tickets even given away for free.

MESSAGE: During Encore, Jay-Z tells the crowd to be really real about what is going on, to trust their own eyes and ears, and to question everything they feel.

BACKGROUND: The previous night brought out Blue Ivy, Scarface, DJ Khaled, and John Legend; the tour opened in July in New York and visited London and Paris.

Why it matters

It celebrates decades of hip-hop history shared live with a packed stadium, and it raises a wider point about checking what we see and hear when technology can trick people.

Test what you remember

1. Where was the final gig of the Jay-Z 30 Tour?

(A) A stadium in Paris
(B) New York's Yankee Stadium
(C) Los Angeles' SoFi Stadium
(D) A stadium in London

2. Who was the first guest to take the stage?

(A) Snoop Dogg
(B) Too Short
(C) Dr. Dre
(D) DJ Khaled

3. Which songs did Jay-Z, Snoop Dogg, and Dr. Dre perform as a medley?

(A) The Next Episode, California Love, Nothin' But a 'G' Thang, and Still D.R.E.
(B) Blow the Whistle and Playoff
(C) God Did and D'Evils
(D) The Story of O.J. and Dead Presidents

4. What did Jay-Z tell the crowd during Encore?

(A) To stop listening to music
(B) To buy more tickets
(C) To believe everything they read online
(D) To trust what they could see and hear for themselves and question everything they feel

5. For which songs did Jay-Z bring out his daughter Blue Ivy the previous night?

(A) The Story of O.J. and Dead Presidents
(B) God Did
(C) California Love
(D) Blow the Whistle

6. Where did the Jay-Z 30 Tour open in July?

(A) With three star-studded nights at New York's Yankee Stadium
(B) With one night in Los Angeles
(C) With a single show in London
(D) With three nights in Paris

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: B 3: A 4: D 5: A 6: A

Questions to think about

1. Jay-Z: He tells the crowd to be really real about what is going on in the world, and to trust what they can see and hear for themselves.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):